the negotiations for a compromise are suspended for the time being.

Thursday, June 15

Nahum Barnea, a foremost political commentator, tells the old story of the frog and the scorpion who arrive at a river they both want to cross. “I will get on your back,” says the scorpion to the frog, “and you will swim across with both of us.” “But,” answers the frog, “you will sting me.” “Why should I do that?” responds the scorpion. “Then we would both die.” The frog is convinced and they set on their way. In the middle of the river, the scorpion stings the frog. “Why did you do that?” asks the dying frog. “It’s my nature,” answers the dying scorpion.

I heard this story in 1961, from a soon-to-be-uncovered Soviet spy, Israel Beer, about Dayan, whom he detested, mainly because Dayan suspected him. Today, it’s told about Bibi, who cannot help thinking in tricks, even when these land him in a stinging defeat. Never mind: new tricks are on the way.

It appears that 30 percent of the budget of the religious school at the Homesh settlement (which the US protested against) is paid by the Ministry of Education.

Friday, June 16

For the coalition, the negotiations at the President’s Residence will not resume; the plan is instead to vote on those laws that the coalition says have been agreed upon (and which the opposition does not consider as such). Obviously, this hides some other and more devious intention.

In the meantime, the Likud is sinking in the polls. In yesterday’s estimate, published by Channel 13, in case of new elections, the coalition